The Phenomenon of the World

Working Paper

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Abstract

The paper develops a line of inquiry shared with speculative realism and object-oriented ontology—the rejection of correlationism and the irreducibility of worlds—but shifts the ontological focus from objects to regimes of fixation and boundaries. Where OOO places the object at the center (autonomous, withdrawn from relations, inexhaustibly deep), this text argues that objects are constituted in fixation; irreducibility is a property of regimes, not of objects; and boundaries are internal conditions of determinacy rather than external limits. The consequences of this shift are threefold. First, it supplies a concrete mechanism of inter-world interaction—not vicarious causation but double fixation, in which one operation becomes determinate in two regimes simultaneously. Second, it provides a structural criterion distinguishing a world (a regime) from a local system of rules within a regime. Third, it is self-applicable: the text about the world is itself a distinction drawn from within, and therefore subject to the same limit and blind spot it describes. The argument proceeds through a phenomenological anatomy of the world (rules, medium, boundary), a distinction between the ontology of the world and the epistemic procedure of belonging, and an analysis of the asymmetry of determinacy and scale—reproduced in mathematics, physics, chemistry, and AI alike. The paper does not claim exhaustiveness; it registers what has been distinguished and leaves open what has not yet received a name.

Keywords: speculative realism, object-oriented ontology, correlationism, fixation, boundary, ontological regimes, world, asymmetry of scale, blind spot, Gödel-likeness, inter-world translation, epistemology of science

Author's Note: This text shares with speculative realism and object-oriented ontology the rejection of correlationism, but argues that the central ontological unit is not the object but the regime of fixation. The consequences of this shift—for interaction, for the criterion of objecthood, and for the self-application of ontological description—are developed in the body of the text. The main body deliberately avoids a literature review and positioning; the present note is intended only to orient readers familiar with OOO and speculative realism, and to signal that the shift

from objects to regimes is not a rejection but a redirection.

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1 Initial Definition: The World as an Autonomous Ontological Regime

The world is that which possesses its own rules of connectivity and transformation, a specific medium, and a boundary of applicability.

To be a world means to set the conditions under which something can be fixed as an object. (Fixation is impersonal: it is not an act of a subject upon an object but the condition under which the distinction between subject and object first becomes possible. This will be argued in §9; here it is noted to prevent reading "fixed" as "fixed by someone.") Fixation here does not denote an act performed by a subject. It names the structural condition under which something acquires determinacy: a relation between rules, medium, and what is distinguished — not an event in a consciousness. Fixation can be realized in a physical interaction, in a measurement, in a logical derivation, or in a biological response; it requires neither an observer nor a mind. This will be developed in §9; here it is stated to prevent a misreading at the point of first introduction. These conditions do not precede the world and are not derived from it: they are the very regime in which reality becomes available for distinction. The rules of connectivity determine what can be related to what within the world; the rules of transformation determine what can follow from what. Within a world its rules are neither justified nor problematized—they function as what makes any "inside" possible. For this reason a world cannot be described by the means it itself provides: its rules precede any description that is carried out within it.

The world possesses a specific medium, in which its events unfold and which sets resistance and possibilities for everything that happens in it. The medium is not a substance in either the physical or the metaphorical sense; it is the mode of the world's embodiment—that of which its inhabitants consist and by which their possibilities are limited. Medium and rules are inseparable: the rules determine what can happen, the medium—in what it happens and by what it is limited.

A world has boundaries of applicability—limits beyond which its rules cease to apply and its medium loses its determinacy. This boundary does not separate the world from the external; it is an internal condition of the world itself. A world is determined not only by what it includes but also by what it excludes—and both together set what it is.

(Clarifying remark: what is at issue is not a refinement of an old concept but a different question: not "what is inside a world" but "by what rules does something become determinate within it." A world is not a spatial container, not an empirical aggregate of objects, and not a subjective psychological construct. Nor is a world a process in the sense of process philosophy (Whitehead, Deleuze): it is not a flow of becoming that precedes and produces its terms. A world is a regime — a set of conditions under which terms acquire determinacy. The difference matters: process philosophy posits becoming as ontologically primary; the ontology of fixation posits neither becoming nor being as primary but asks under what conditions either becomes available for distinction.)

2 The Constitutive Traits of the World

A world possesses six invariant characteristics that do not depend on its medium—whatever that medium may be: physical, semantic, phenomenal, normative, and so on.

Every world possesses its own set of rules—logical, physical, aesthetic—which determine what within it is possible, true, or admissible. These rules are not dictated from outside and are not derived from the rules of another world. An attempt to apply the rules of one world to another leads to a category error.

A world is always embodied in a specific medium, which is the mode of its embodiment, setting resistance and possibilities for everything that happens in it. For the physical world it is mass and field—to the extent that we describe it; for the semantic world, sign and meaning; for the phenomenal world, qualia.

In a world there exist objects, processes, or patterns; their identity and properties are determined by the world in which they are found. Such objects, or rather their examples, once named, are to a known degree non-authentic abstractions, not identical to what they are in a concrete world. These examples are needed so that we can at least somehow define the phenomenon of the world. Outside its world, its objects either disappear or become something else: musical notes on paper are a physical object, but as music they exist only in the world of sounds and meanings.

Elements within a world form a network of interconnections in which a change in one element entails predictable—by the rules of that world—changes in others. A world is a system of relations.

A world has boundaries of applicability—limits beyond which its rules cease to apply and its medium loses its determinacy. A world is determined not only by what it includes but also by what it excludes; and this excludedness is constitutive of its identity.

No world is self-contained for describing the whole of reality. Within every world there are questions that cannot be posed from within it: physics cannot answer why physics itself exists; mathematics cannot justify its axioms without exiting into metamathematics. A world needs something external to its rules in order to be finally meaningful. This "external" is not a spatial "outside": it is a logical condition of meaningfulness without which a world cannot be thought as a whole.

The six traits describe not just any system of rules but the regime in which systems of rules exist. Chess, bureaucracy, or hallucination are not worlds in this sense: they are objects or processes within this or that regime. Where the boundary between a regime and a local system of rules lies is a question not resolved here; it belongs to the open periphery of the definition.

3 The Distinction between the Ontology of the World and the Epistemic Procedure of Belonging

Statements such as "the cell belongs to the biological world" or "the thought belongs to the ideal world" fix not an ontological fact but a secondary operation. This distinction must be drawn

with all rigor, since the entire subsequent understanding of the phenomenon of the world depends on it.

The world, as has been established, is that which possesses its own rules of connectivity and transformation, a specific medium, and boundaries of applicability. Belonging to a world is something else: connections are laid into the framework of one set of rules, and everything that does not fit into these rules remains outside the fixation.

The distinction rests on three propositions.

First: an object does not precede fixation with respect to belonging. The world sets the conditions under which something can be fixed as an object. An object is determined by being fixed in this or that regime. In each fixation it will be a different object—with different properties, identity, and causal structure. To ask to which world an object belongs "in reality" means to assume that belonging is a property of its own rather than the result of fixation.

Second: belonging is not a property of the object. The properties of an object are determined by the world in which it is found: the rules of this world set what is possible, true, or admissible for it. Belonging is not among these properties—it is the result of fixation in which the object first acquires properties in a given regime. To ascribe belonging to an object means to turn fixation into a characteristic of the object.

Third: boundaries between worlds are established in fixation. Separation arises when the connections of an object are laid into the framework of a concrete set of rules and thereby the remaining dimensions are cut off. Fixation does not open a boundary—it establishes one. In this sense belonging is the result of a distinction performed at the moment when the object becomes determinate.

(Clarifying remark: belonging is not an ontological property of an object; confusing it with the ontology of the world gives rise to a category error.)

(Additional clarification: if the three fixations of one event—tissue damage, pain, danger signal—mutually limit each other, this does not presuppose a common substrate in which the limitation takes place. Mutual limitation does not require a shared substance; it requires a shared boundary. Two regimes can limit each other without sharing a medium, provided the boundary between them is itself an operation rather than a thing. To demand a common substrate is to apply the grammar of substance to a structural relation—the same category error identified in the first proposition.)

From these three propositions it follows that the question "to which world does an object belong?" must be replaced by the question "in which regime and through what fixation did the object become determinate?" The first question presupposes a ready set of worlds and ready objects awaiting distribution. The second asks about the fixation in the course of which both worlds and objects first become determinate.

This distinction becomes evident not through negation but through the direct contemplation of how irreducible worlds are to one another.

The prick of a needle: in the physiological regime it becomes determinate as tissue damage, in the phenomenal regime as pain, in the semantic regime as a signal of danger. These are not three objects but three fixations of one event; in each fixation the event is different, and none is the "real" one.

4 Consequences of the Distinction

The distinction drawn restructures a number of traditional notions. Below are four consequences, each of which changes the formulation of the question rather than only the answer to it.

First: the question of "real" belonging is removed. An object does not belong to one world preferentially over others. In each fixation it becomes determinate in this or that regime, and in each it is a different object. Therefore the dispute over whether consciousness is "really" physical or ideal, gravity material or mathematical, is not a dispute about a fact but a clash of different fixations. It cannot be resolved by pointing to an object, because an object outside fixation has no determinacy with respect to belonging.

Second: relations are primary with respect to the list of worlds. A world is determined not by which objects are in it but by which rules of connectivity and transformation operate in it. The list of worlds is therefore not an inventory that can be compiled once and for all. It is a list of regimes, each of which is set by its own rules and its own medium. Worlds differ not by what is in them but by the way in which something becomes determinate in them.

Third: worlds are juxtaposed, not subordinated. From the distinction it follows that worlds do not form a hierarchy from the "basic" to the "superstructural." The physical world does not lie at the foundation of the semantic, nor the semantic at the foundation of the phenomenal. Each world is autonomous in its rules and its medium; relations between them are established not in the order of subordination but in the order of fixation, which can translate determinacy from one regime to another. The notion of a hierarchy of worlds is a by-product of the procedure of classification, not an ontology.

Fourth: boundaries of worlds are operational rather than ontological. The boundary between worlds does not run "in nature as such" as a line dividing two domains. It is established in fixation—at the moment when the connections of an object are laid into the framework of one set of rules and the remaining dimensions are cut off. This means that the boundaries of a world are not its external limit separating it from another world; they are an internal condition of its determinacy.

Juxtaposition does not mean isolation. Worlds are not separated from one another: they touch in fixation, which translates determinacy from one regime to another. But how exactly this happens is not described here: the section fixes the fact of juxtaposition and irreducibility, while the mechanism of transition requires a language that is introduced in the next section.

(Clarifying remark: what has been said does not mean that worlds are illusory or that the difference between them is conventional. Worlds are real as regimes; what is conventional is not their reality but the procedure of ascribing objects to them.)

From these four consequences there follows a general reorientation of the question. To ask to which world an object belongs means to seek an answer where there is none: in the object taken before fixation. To ask which rules and which medium set the determinacy of an object in a given fixation means to ask about what can actually be established.

5 The Radical Irreducibility of Worlds

The distinction drawn in §3 becomes evident not through negation but through the direct contemplation of how irreducible worlds are to one another. Below are four examples which do not exhaust the list but make this irreducibility tangible.

First example: the physical world. A stone falls. It has mass, it occupies a place in space, its motion is subject to gravitation and thermodynamics. It can be destroyed, weighed, measured. Its existence does not depend on whether anyone looks at it. The rules of this world are causal relations, spatial extension, the arrow of time. The medium is mass and field.

Second example: the semantic and mathematical world. The Pythagorean theorem. It has no mass, cannot be weighed, does not occupy a place in space. It is atemporal: a theorem proved in antiquity remains identical to itself today; it does not age and is not subject to entropy. If all physical carriers—books, servers—were burned, the physical world would change, but the structure of meaning itself would not burn; it would merely lose the actual mode of its embodiment. The rules of this world are logical consequence, consistency, semantic relations. The medium is sign and meaning.

Third example: the phenomenal world. Acute toothache. This is a reality of strict privacy. A neurosurgeon can see an inflamed nerve on an image, but he cannot experience this pain. Spatial coordinates are absent here: pain has no geometric length. Time is plastic: a minute of agonizing waiting subjectively lasts longer than an hour of joy. This world exists only for someone; it is unthinkable without a point of reference. The rules are intentionality, emotional coloring, subjective duration. The medium is qualia.

Fourth example: the normative and institutional world. A criminal code or the status of a hundred-dollar bill. Physically, a bill is colored paper. Semantically, it is a symbol with numbers. But its value is a fact of this very world. This world possesses a paradoxical force: being immaterial and existing only as long as the community believes in it, it is capable of physically restricting bodies—putting a person in prison—and reshaping landscapes—building factories. The rules are obligation, permission, legitimacy, collective recognition. The medium is norms and institutions.

The normative world does not act on the physical world causally: it acts through fixation. One and the same operation—detention—becomes determinate both as a physical constraint and as a normative act. These are not two actions but two fixations of one operation.

The irreducibility of these worlds manifests itself most vividly at the moment when we try to apply the rules of one world to another. This inevitably leads to a category error. It is senseless to demand of a metaphor that it comply with the law of conservation of energy. It is impossible

to prove the truth of a mathematical equation with a microscope. It is absurd to look in the brain for the spatial coordinates of a feeling of guilt. It is useless to try to refute a court verdict by chemical analysis of the ink with which it is signed.

It is crucial to note: when we speak of four fixations of one event (stone, theorem, pain, law), this does not mean that a common substrate stands behind them, manifesting differently in each fixation. "One event" here is not the name of a third thing standing behind the four regimes, but the name of their mutual limitation taken as a whole. If all four fixations are removed, the "event" does not remain—just as "detention" does not remain without the detainer and the detained. The grammar of "one event" is the grammar of a relation, not of a thing. To demand a common substrate is to apply to a relation the grammar appropriate to a thing; it is precisely this error that generates classical problems like psychophysical parallelism.

Each of these worlds is autonomous. They are not illusions or superstructures one above another. Stone, theorem, pain, and law are not four descriptions of the same object but four fundamentally different ways in which reality becomes available for distinction. The recognition of this radical irreducibility is a necessary step toward understanding what a world is.

6 The Boundary as an Internal Condition of the World

The boundary of one world does not separate it from another like a line or a wall. It is like a horizon: it cannot be fixed as an object, yet it sets a perspective—what is visible from within the world. It is an internal condition of the world itself: what sets its determinacy, not what limits it from outside. The latter would be a return to the "container" logic we abandoned at the outset.

This becomes clear if we distinguish two aspects of the boundary.

First: a world has limits of explanatory power—there where its rules cease to apply. In the physical world these are the Planck scale, where the concepts of distance and duration lose their determinacy. This limit is structural: it does not depend on the specific interpretation of quantum mechanics or cosmology (whether formalized through wave function collapse, branching worlds, hidden variables, or modified gravity), but rather indicates that the concepts formed for intermediate scales exhaust themselves at the boundaries of the regime. In the mathematical world, the incompleteness theorems, where a system cannot justify its own axioms by its own means. In the phenomenal world, thresholds of perception beyond which experience becomes indistinguishable. The limit is not something external to the world: it is a limit regime in which the former rules exhaust themselves. A world is determined not only by what it includes but also by where its rules cease to act.

The second aspect is a consequence of the limit being internal. The rules of a world set what can be fixed in it; that which they do not provide for cannot be grasped even in a question. There appears in a world a domain about which it itself is unable to say anything—not because knowledge has not yet been attained, but because there is nothing with which to ask: the question cannot be assembled from its own rules. We shall call this domain the **blind spot**.

The blind spot is not ignorance—it is the inability to pose a question, not the absence of an

answer. Physics cannot answer why physics itself exists: the question requires going beyond its rules, and within them it has no application. Mathematics cannot justify its axioms without exiting into metamathematics. This is not a gap in knowledge that can be filled: the question does not compose from the rules and conditions of the world itself.

The difference between limit and blind spot is essential. The limit we can fix—not as an object but as a condition: we know that the rules are exhausted and under what circumstances this happens. The blind spot cannot be fixed: the question is not formulated, and we cannot indicate even the direction in which to seek it. The limit opens a perspective; the blind spot extinguishes it.

Both aspects are necessary. A world in which the rules are not exhausted would be indeterminate: it would be impossible to say what is possible in it and what is not. A world without a blind spot would be closed and self-contained: it could justify itself from within. But it is precisely non-closure that makes a world a world: it needs the external—not spatially external but logically external—in order to be meaningful as a whole. This "external" is not another world and not an "outside": it is a condition of meaningfulness without which a world cannot be thought as a world.

7 Systematization as Distinction

If the boundary is defined as an internal condition of the world, then the description of a world is a description not of what is in it but of its boundaries. The systematization of traits that we carry out is a list not of objects but of conditions of distinguishability.

Hence a question that usually remains unspoken: how is such systematization possible if the complexity of reality at every point is, apparently, infinite? If no selected fragment has a "bottom" at which one can stop, then any list of traits looks arbitrary. Classical thought knows two exits, and both are unsatisfactory. The first is to pretend that complexity is finite and fully describable; this is reductionism. The second is to declare it unknowable and to renounce distinctions; this is mysticism. Both exits are consequences of one error: they assume that infinite complexity can be exhausted.

We do otherwise. Systematization fixes not the world in all its fullness but stable traits in which reality responds to a certain way of posing a question. Infinite complexity does not cancel the fact that at certain scales and in certain regimes it gives a recurring response—stable enough to be distinguished and named. We distinguish not objects but what makes an object distinguishable: rules, medium, boundaries of applicability. Each trait in this list is not a property of the world but a condition under which something in it becomes determinate.

From this it follows that the traits we distinguish are not properties of the world but operations of distinction. Their value lies not in corresponding to objects but in allowing a distinction to be held where without them everything would merge. To hold a distinction while knowing of its conventionality is not a compromise but a form of rigor: we do not pass off a performed distinction as a property of the world itself, but we do not renounce it either.

There is another side. Any of the traits can be revised—not because it is erroneous but because

the conditions of distinction change together with scale and regime. The list is therefore not closed and does not claim exhaustiveness; it registers what has already been distinguished and leaves room for what has not yet received a name. This is not a weakness but a condition of its work—a closed list would cease to be a list and would pass itself off as the world itself.

8 The Paradox of Operationalization

The concept "world" allows one to distinguish regimes, describe their rules and boundaries. But the concept itself has a limit. This is not a defect that can be eliminated by refinement; it is a consequence of the concept being operational: it describes not what the world is but the conditions under which something in it becomes determinate.

Asymmetry of determinacy. The limit of the concept manifests itself primarily in the situation we shall designate as the asymmetry of determinacy. The determinacy of an object's belonging to such-and-such a world is achieved only in a narrow range of scales—there where the rules and medium still work. A stone, a lamppost: here belonging is determinate—it is confirmed by resistance and weight, and when a forehead collides with a lamppost, pain and resistance are irrefutable here and now. But one has only to step beyond this range—toward the microworld, where the concepts of distance and duration lose their determinacy, or toward the macroworld, where the boundaries of the fixation regime dissolve—and the stone ceases to be a stone: it becomes a cloud of probabilities or a curvature of the metric. The question "to which world does this belong" loses a determinate answer—not because knowledge has not yet been attained, but because the conditions of fixation on which the answer rests no longer hold there.

This is not a feature of human access to the world. The same asymmetry is reproduced in any fixation: in mathematics, as the incompleteness of a formal system that cannot justify its own axioms by its own means; in physics, as indeterminacy arising in the attempt to fix conjugate quantities simultaneously; in chemistry, as the loss of the concept of "substance" at scales where quantum effects are significant; in AI, as the collapse of a stable category beyond the boundaries of the training set. Everywhere determinacy is local: it holds in the middle of the range and fades at the boundaries. This is structural isomorphism, not a transfer of the human measure onto nature.

Asymmetry of scale. This indeterminacy has a direction. Movement "inward"—toward smaller scales, toward more minute distinctions—encounters a rigid limit: beyond it distinction is impossible, the rules are exhausted, the medium loses its determinacy (see §6). Movement "outward"—toward complexification, integration, encompassment of the greater—has no such limit: any attained level can be included in a more complex one. From this it follows that any definition of a concrete world is scale-dependent and temporary: what at one level looks like an autonomous world may at another turn out to be a fluctuation or, conversely, a particular manifestation of a more encompassing structure. The asymmetry of scale is not a consequence of ignorance but a property of the very relation between a world and its fixation.

The determinacy of an object's belonging to a world is achieved only where the rules and medium still work; beyond this range the question of belonging loses a determinate answer. This does not

weaken the concept "world" but indicates the condition of its work.

9 Anthropocentrism as a Structural Invariant

The asymmetry of determinacy and of scale was shown to be a property of fixation reproduced in mathematics, physics, chemistry, AI—everywhere that something becomes determinate within rules and a medium. There remains a question that usually stays in the background: if determinacy is always local and always has a boundary, is this picture itself not a projection of the human mode of cognition onto the structure of the world? Is not "world," as described, an anthropomorphism, albeit a refined one?

This question must be considered directly, because the status of everything preceding depends on the answer to it.

Anthropocentrism as a structural invariant. The assertion that the world is structured as described is inseparable from the mode in which it is described: description is always conducted from within a certain regime of fixation, and this regime sets what can appear in the description and what cannot. This is not a feature of the human. Any system of fixation—a human, an instrument, an AI, a mathematical procedure—describes the world from within a certain set of rules and in a certain medium, and its description is always limited by these rules and this medium. Anthropocentrism in this sense does not mean "the human at the center of the world"; it means that fixation is always conducted from within, not from an external standpoint, and that no external standpoint exists. This is a structural invariant, not an anthropological privilege.

This structural invariant must be distinguished from correlationism in the sense defined by Meillassoux: the thesis that being is always already being-for-us, that we cannot think being without thinking our access to it. The invariant described here is not correlationist, because fixation is not identified with human access. A Geiger counter fixes radiation without consciousness; a formal system fixes derivability without interpretation; a cell membrane fixes chemical gradients without representation. What is invariant is not that fixation requires a subject but that it requires a regime — rules, medium, boundary. The absence of an external standpoint is not the presence of a human one; it is the structural condition of any registration whatsoever.

Hence the dual role of this invariant. On the one hand, it is the condition of the possibility of description: without fixation from within there would be neither objects, nor boundaries, nor a world as a regime. On the other hand, it is a source of limitation: what fixation sets, it also limits; what it allows one to see, it also cuts off. Every description carries within itself the germ of its own limit—not because it is insufficiently complete, but because it is conducted from within.

The impossibility of external purification. From this it follows that anthropocentrism cannot be eliminated by stepping beyond its limits. The external standpoint from which one could describe the world "as it is" does not exist: any attempt to occupy such a standpoint is itself a fixation from within some regime. This applies to AI as well. AI is not a neutral mirror: the data on which it is trained, the architecture, the language in which it responds—all these are products of human activity, and its "external" position is always already embedded in the human

slice. AI makes anthropocentrism more complex and mediated but does not abolish it: it fixes from within its regime just as a human does from within his own.

Hence an important clarification: the anthropocentrism in question is not a psychological attitude that can be overcome by effort. It is a structural condition of fixation as such. One cannot say of it that "we are free of it" or "we are not free of it": the very formulation of the question presupposes an external standpoint that does not exist.

Isomorphism of world and cognition. If fixation is always conducted from within, then the structure of the world and the structure of fixation cannot be independent. The world is that which sets determinacy; fixation is that in which determinacy arises. These are not two different objects but one relation considered from two sides: from the side of what is set and from the side of how it is set. From this it follows that the structure of the world and the structure of cognition are isomorphic—not because cognition "reflects" the world and not because the world "is superimposed" on cognition, but because it is one and the same structure unfolded in different registers.

Concretely, this means:

- **The boundaries of the world and the boundaries of distinction coincide.** What was described as limit and blind spot manifests itself in cognition as the limit of explanatory power and the impossibility of posing a question. These are not two different boundaries but one, visible from two sides.
- **The asymmetry of scale is reproduced in the movement of thought.** Deepening into foundations—toward axioms, definitions, initial distinctions—encounters a rigid limit: beyond it distinction is impossible or generates a paradox. Generalization—toward synthesis, toward encompassment of the greater—has no such limit: any attained level can be included in a more complex one.
- **The blind spot of the world and the blind spot of cognition coincide.** The questions that cannot be posed from within a world are the same questions that cannot be formulated by the means of cognition operating in that world.

This does not mean that the world reduces to cognition or cognition to the world. It means that the difference between them is not the difference of two objects but the difference of two sides of one relation. The world is not created by fixation, but world and fixation are two descriptions of one and the same: of how something becomes determinate.

Consequence. The isomorphism of world and cognition is not a metaphysical assertion about the identity of being and thought. It is a structural consequence of the fact that fixation is always conducted from within. If an external standpoint existed, world and cognition could diverge; since it does not exist, they cannot diverge in principle—not because they coincide, but because the difference between them has no place where it could arise. This does not weaken the concept of the world but refines its status: the world is that which sets determinacy and at the same time that which becomes determinate in fixation. Both sides are not two objects but one.

10 Scaling as a Procedure. Gödel-Likeness

Systematization was defined as distinction: a list not of objects but of conditions of distinguishability. It was shown that the structure of the world and the structure of fixation are isomorphic. From this it follows that the distinction drawn in the text is subject to the same conditions as any fixation: it has rules, a medium, and boundaries. In particular, the asymmetry of scale applies to it. This is not a transfer of a property onto cognition—it is the same invariant considered from the side of the procedure rather than from the side of its object.

Scaling as a procedure. Distinction can be conducted in two directions. The first—"inward": toward foundations, definitions, initial distinctions from which the rest is derived. The second—"outward": toward synthesis, generalization, inclusion of the given distinction in a broader one. The asymmetry of scale is reproduced here in full. Movement "inward" encounters a rigid limit: beyond it distinction either becomes impossible (definition runs into the undefinable) or generates a paradox (a system justifying itself by its own means). Movement "outward" has no such limit: any attained generalization can be included in the next one.

Hence the first consequence for the method: one should not expect depth and breadth to be mirror-like. Deepening is finite; generalization is open. A distinction that looks weak in movement "inward" may be strong in movement "outward," and vice versa. The evaluation of a distinction depends on the direction in which it is tested.

Gödel-likeness. The pairing "definition of a world—content of a world" reveals the same asymmetry in an extremely sharp form. A world, defined as that which possesses rules, a medium, and a boundary of applicability, cannot be exhaustively defined from within itself: definition requires means that themselves belong to the world and therefore cannot be laid as the foundation of its definition. This is a structural analogue of the incompleteness of a formal system: a system cannot justify its own axioms by its own means. The limit here is not a defect of definition but a consequence of the fact that definition is conducted from within.

In the opposite direction—in the transition from definition to content—no limit is discovered. The content of a world is always in excess with respect to its definition: any act of distinction that refines the concept generates new connections, new questions, new distinctions that were not provided for by the definition. This is not infinity in a pejorative sense but openness: the definition sets conditions, the content overflows them.

Gödel-likeness is thus neither a logical error nor a paradox. It is the "signature" characteristic of any distinction conducted from within: a solid but limited core and an open, inexhaustible periphery. It is the same that was described as limit and blind spot, and also as the asymmetry of determinacy and of scale, but taken from the side of the procedure of definition rather than from the side of its object.

A clarification is needed to forestall a possible objection: if every distinction has a solid core and an open periphery, is Gödel-likeness not a rhetorical shield that makes the framework unfalsifiable? No. Gödel-likeness is not an empirical hypothesis that could be refuted by accumulating data; it is a structural necessity derived from the nature of any sufficiently complex formal system.

Gödel's incompleteness theorems show that any system capable of expressing its own syntax cannot prove its own consistency from within. This is not a contingent fact about our current state of knowledge but a formal result about the structure of self-referential systems. If physics resolves its current paradoxes, it will not abolish Gödel-likeness but merely relocate the blind spot: a new formal system will generate a new limit and a new blind spot. The thesis is falsifiable in only one case: if a closed system could be constructed that fully justifies itself from within without remainder. But this is mathematically impossible. Therefore Gödel-likeness is not a shield against criticism but a map showing where criticism can be productive and where it cannot.

Consequences. From what has been said there follow three requirements for the distinction drawn in this text.

First—diagnostics through limits. A distinction is tested not by internal smoothness but by its behavior at the edges of scale: if it disintegrates upon deepening and becomes trivial upon generalization, this is a sign that it does not hold the distinction. A stable distinction exhibits Gödel-likeness: a solid core and an open periphery.

Second—self-application. The text about the world is itself a distinction drawn from within, and everything said applies to it. Its definitions have a limit beyond which the undefinable begins, and an open periphery in which they generate new distinctions. This does not weaken the text but indicates its status: it does not claim exhaustiveness, it registers what has been distinguished and leaves room for what has not yet received a name.

Third—renunciation of the external standpoint. Neither the definition of the world nor its content can be described from a position external to fixation. This means that the question "the world as a whole" has no formulation that would not already be a distinction within the world. The world as a whole is not given; given are the distinctions conducted in it and their boundaries.

11 Summary: The World as a Boundary Event

The world is that which sets determinacy: rules of connectivity and transformation, medium, boundaries of applicability (§1–§2). Determinacy does not precede fixation—it arises in it: an object acquires properties, identity, and causal structure only by being fixed in this or that regime (§3). In each fixation it is a different object; to ask to which world it belongs "in reality" means to seek the result of an operation where there was as yet no operation.

The boundary of the world, moreover, does not separate it from the external: it is an internal condition of its determinacy (§6). It has two aspects. The limit is fixed as a condition: it is known where the rules are exhausted and under what circumstances. The blind spot is not fixed: the question cannot be assembled from the means of the world itself, and it is impossible to indicate the direction in which to seek it. Both aspects are necessary: a world without a limit would be indeterminate, a world without a blind spot would be closed.

From this it follows that the systematization of the traits of a world is a distinction of conditions of distinguishability, not a list of objects (§7). Its value lies not in corresponding to objects but in the capacity to hold a distinction where without it everything would merge. And it is not closed:

any trait can be revised if the conditions of distinction change.

The asymmetry of determinacy and of scale (§8) is not a feature of human access to the world. It is reproduced in any fixation: in mathematics, physics, chemistry, AI. Determinacy is local: it holds in the middle of the range and fades at the boundaries. Movement "inward" encounters a limit, movement "outward" has none. This is a structural invariant, not an anthropological privilege.

Hence anthropocentrism as a structural invariant (§9): fixation is always conducted from within, no external standpoint exists, and this condition is shared equally by a human, an instrument, an AI, and a mathematical procedure. The isomorphism of world and cognition is not the identity of being and thought but a consequence of the fact that the difference between them has no place where it could arise.

Finally, Gödel-likeness (§10): a distinction conducted from within has a solid but limited core and an open, inexhaustible periphery. This is the "signature" characteristic of any distinction—and of this text itself. It does not claim exhaustiveness; it registers what has been distinguished and leaves room for what has not yet received a name.

Hence the final formula. The world is not that which contains being. The world is a boundary event on which a transition from one register to another occurs. In the act of translation—and not in the "depth" of a container—there is born what we call objects and their properties. Objects are the frozen traces of successful acts of translation; the question shifts from "what is inside a world" and "to which world does an object belong" to "by what rules does something become determinate in it, and where do the boundaries run at which fixation loses force."

This description is closed upon itself: it is itself a distinction conducted from within, and everything said in it applies to it. But precisely for this reason it also indicates its own limit—and the necessity of a language that would allow one to describe the acts of translation themselves not as a list of traits but as operations. Such a language is the subject of the next section.

12 Consequences

This section adds no new content to what has been said. It fixes what follows from what has been said for a number of domains of inquiry—not in the sense of "where this can be applied" but in the sense of "what this changes in the formulation of questions."

For AI research. The distinction between limit and blind spot (§6) and the asymmetry of determinacy (§8) provide an apparatus for understanding the limitations of large language models. From them it follows that a model cannot be an all-knowing mirror of reality—not because it lacks data or power, but because an all-knowing mirror is structurally impossible: fixation is always conducted from within and always has a blind spot. The errors of a model are not a defect eliminable by scaling but a consequence of the nature of fixation: determinacy is local and fades at the boundaries of the range. This is not an evaluation of AI but a description of the condition in which it works.

For digital ontologies and virtual environment studies. The distinction between a regime

and a local system of rules (§2) allows one to describe virtual environments without reducing them either to code or to narrative. A game mechanic is not a world but a system of rules within a regime; a virtual environment is not a container of objects but a regime of fixation. This is not a new theory of the virtual but an application of what has been said to a class of objects that is otherwise described either as "just code" or as "just text."

For interdisciplinary research. If worlds are irreducible but touch in fixation (§4), then the task of interdisciplinary research is not the search for a common denominator (reduction to physics) and not the acknowledgment of incommensurability (postmodernism) but the description of the translation of determinacy at the boundaries of regimes. This is a third path, sketched in §4; the mechanism of translation remains beyond the limits of this section, but the formulation of the question itself changes: instead of "how to reduce one to the other"—"how to describe the transition."

For the epistemology of science. The difference between limit and blind spot (§6) allows one to reformulate crises in science not as temporary failures but as encounters with the constitutive boundaries of a research regime. The Planck scale, incompleteness theorems, thresholds of perception are not gaps that will be filled but points at which the rules of the regime are exhausted. This does not cancel concrete research but refines what exactly it finds when it finds a "limit."

General consequence. All four domains point in one direction: the description of the world as a regime of fixation requires a language that would describe the acts of translation themselves—not as a list of traits but as operations. Such a language is the subject of the next section. Here it is important only to register: what has been said does not claim exhaustiveness in any of the domains listed; it indicates what changes in them if one accepts the distinction drawn in §1–§11, and where the limit of this section runs.

AI Use Disclosure

During the preparation of this work, the author used AI tools exclusively for stylistic and technical editing to improve readability. After using these tools, the output was carefully reviewed, edited, and verified by the author, who takes full responsibility for the conceptual architecture, analysis, and final content of the paper.

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